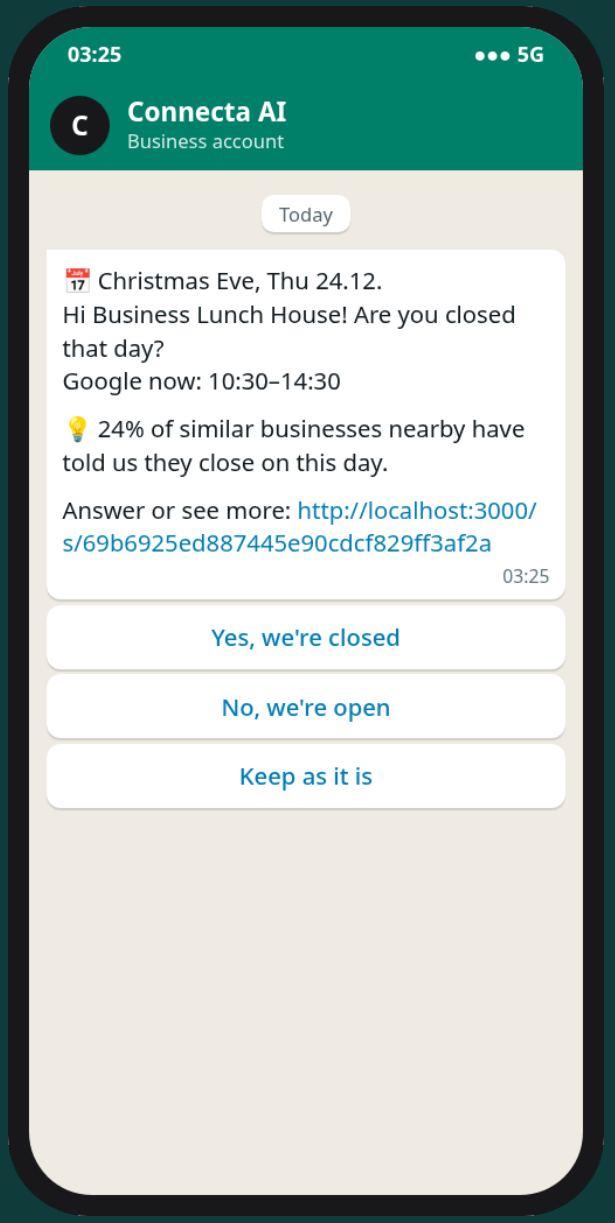
SINCE AI HACKATHON 2026 · FONECTA CHALLENGE

Connect Suggests

No customer walks to a closed door.

Connect notices when a business's holiday hours are about to be wrong, suggests the right hours with the reason, and the owner approves in one tap.

Team Token Burners



Holiday hours go wrong when they matter most

Owners forget

Today the owner logs in and enters exception hours themselves. Many forget, or have no time.

Customers walk to a closed door

Google keeps showing normal hours on Christmas Eve, New Year's Day and Epiphany.

Visibility drops when demand peaks

Missing or outdated hours can drop a business out of "open now" searches.

6 in 10

holiday dates where the owner has never entered hours for that holiday

6,616 of 11,100 days for 802 businesses, 2026 season. There is nothing of their own to copy, so Connect has to work it out.

One loop, five steps, and the owner decides



1 Detect

Finds the special days where Google will show the wrong hours.



2 Suggest

Proposes hours, with the reasons and how sure it is.



3 Contact

One message at a time, in the owner's language, channel and contact hours.



4 Decide

Yes, no or edit, in one tap. No login.



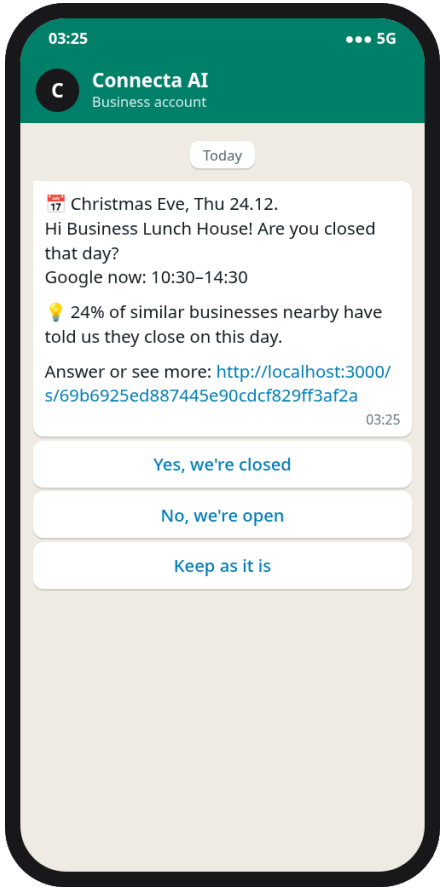
5 Apply

Written to Yext. The owner sees where the new hours show.

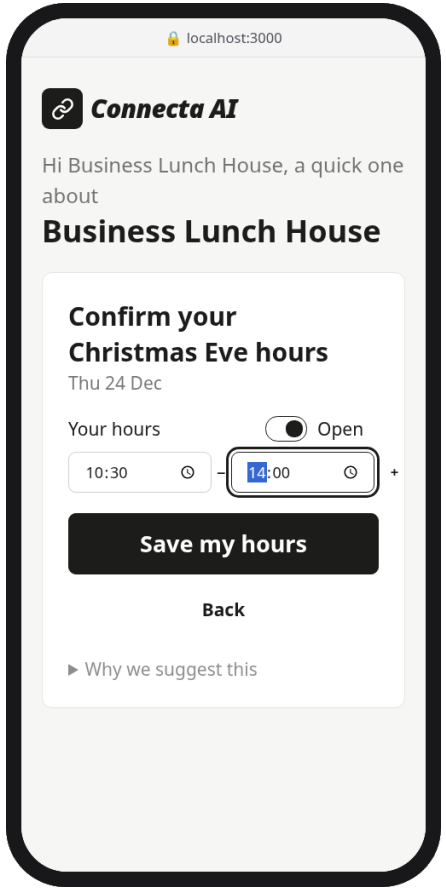


And it learns. Every answer goes back to the predictor, and the business is predicted again within seconds.

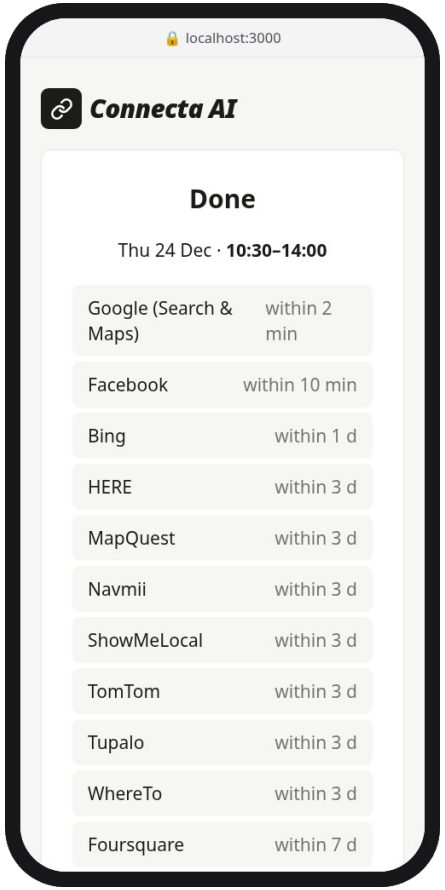
The owner answers in one tap, without logging in



1 WhatsApp: a yes-or-no question, with buttons



2 Or edit the hours on a page that needs no login



3 Saved to our real Yext sandbox, with where it shows

Finnish, Swedish, Norwegian and English

WhatsApp, Telegram and email, sent for real

Waits for the owner's contact hours. Owners who opted out get nothing

Business Lunch House is a test business in our Yext sandbox, read and written through the live Yext API.

How the predictor decides one day

Every special day

Each business, each day from 7 Nov 2026 to 6 Jan 2027.

First checks

Shut down for good? Flag it. Owner already answered the day? Stay quiet.

Clues propose hours

Each with the evidence behind it, and a reason the owner can read.

The model scores them

It predicts the points each option would earn on the organisers' scale.

Each day ends in one of three ways

Suggest

when it expects to be right more often than wrong

Stay quiet

otherwise. Most owners without history keep their normal hours

Flag for a person

when customers say the business has shut down for good

A full run decides every day in about 20 seconds on a laptop, with no internet and only Python's standard library.

Every clue brings its own evidence

The owner's history

The same holiday in earlier years, moved to this year's weekday. Surer when the years agree.

The shopping centre

Shops used the hours their centre published about 85% of the time.

Customer reviews

"Doors already closed at 16:20" becomes "closes at 16:00". About 9 in 10 "closed" readings were right.

New normal hours

"Now only open Mon-Fri 10-18" in a review matched the true hours on 112 of 112 weekdays.

Similar businesses and the type

88% of businesses like Kahvila Kipinä were closed on Christmas Day in earlier years.

Snow, seasons, Google edits

Ski rentals were always closed with under 10 cm of snow. Summer terraces close for the winter.

Language models read. A trained model decides.

Reading reviews

"Tultiin uudenvuodenpäivänä klo 16.20 ja ovet olivat jo kiinni. Netissä oli eri ajat."

We came on New Year's Day at 16:20 and the doors were already closed. The internet had different hours.

Next New Year's Day: closes at 16:00

Qwen2.5-72B reads Finnish, Mistral-Small 24B Swedish and Norwegian, through Featherless. All 1,350 reviews cost about 10 cents.

Deciding

Decision trees trained on past seasons, replayed as if they were happening live:

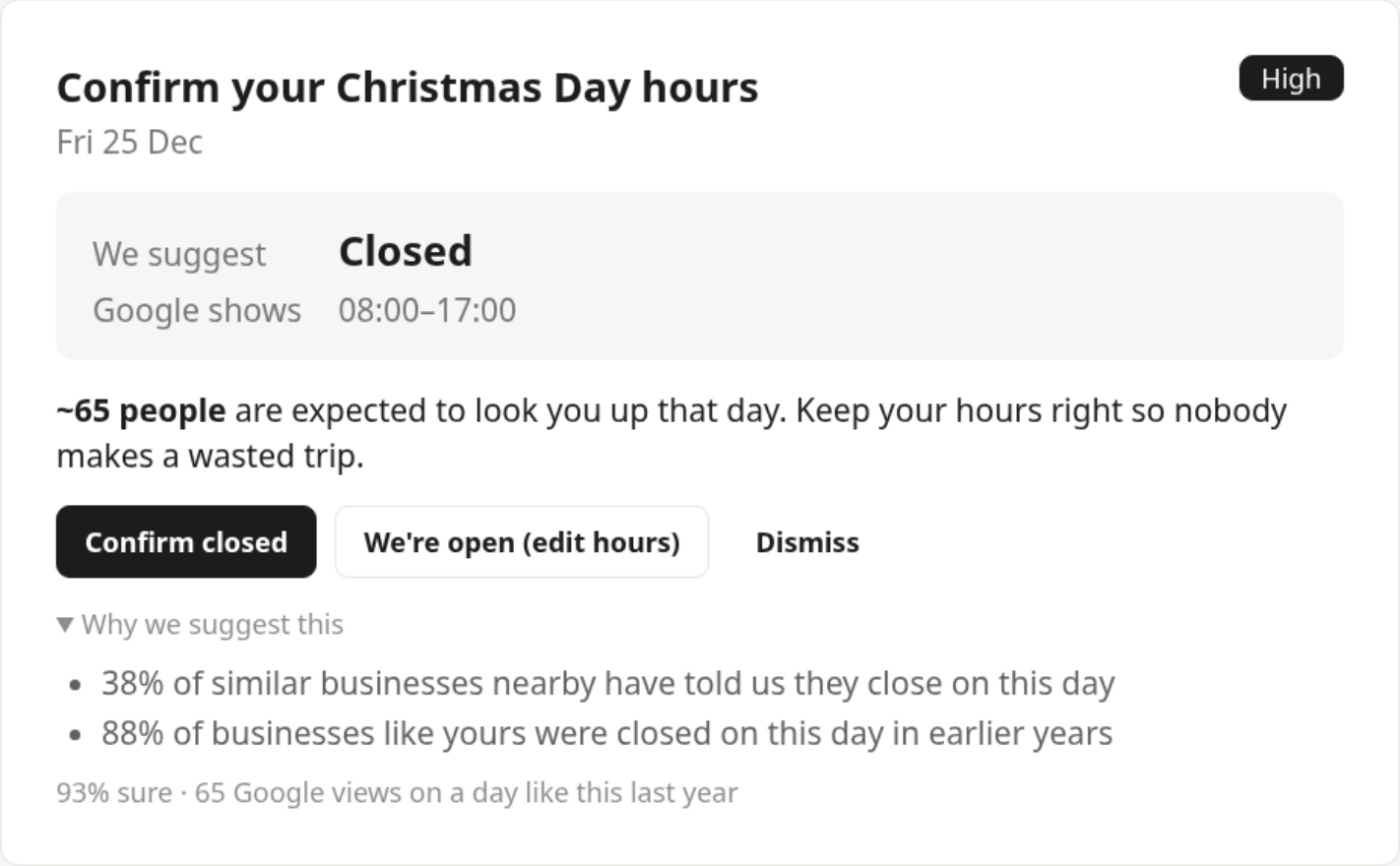
Winter 2024 **Winter 2025** **Springs 2024-26** **2025 pilot answers**

Each season starts from its own snapshot date, with only what was known then. Every possible suggestion is scored the way the organisers score.

So it learns how far to trust each clue: last year's hours from an owner who updates every year, more than from one who skipped two years.

A language model deciding on its own: **17.7%** Our trained model: **36.7%** (on the days owners never told us about, 39 businesses)

A new customer with no history still gets suggestions



Kahvila Kipinä, a café in Turku, had never entered any holiday hours

It gets five suggestions, each with its reasons and how sure it is

Nothing on days where the evidence is weak: most owners without history keep their normal hours

One answer improves the next suggestion

Before: 51% sure

Confirm your Epiphany hours Low

Wed 6 Jan

We suggest **Closed**
Google shows 08:00–17:00

~27 people are expected to look you up that day. Keep your hours right so nobody makes a wasted trip.

Confirm closed | **We're open (edit hours)** | **Dismiss**

▼ Why we suggest this

- 54% of businesses like yours were closed on this day in earlier years

51% sure · 27 Google views on a day like this last year

Owner confirms Christmas Day closed

After: 64% sure, with a new reason

Confirm your Epiphany hours Low

Wed 6 Jan

We suggest **Closed**
Google shows 08:00–17:00

~27 people are expected to look you up that day. Keep your hours right so nobody makes a wasted trip.

Confirm closed | **We're open (edit hours)** | **Dismiss**

▼ Why we suggest this

- You were closed on most of the special days you have told us about

64% sure · 27 Google views on a day like this last year

Within seconds

Every answer, on any channel, predicts the business again.

Declined means no

Declined hours are never suggested again for that holiday.

Standing permission

"Handle public holidays without asking", applied only when at least 70% sure.

68.3% on businesses the model never saw

68.3%

with the organisers' own scorer, 2026 season

54.5%

the organisers' baseline

65.2%

2025 back-test, using only what was known on 6 Nov 2025

When the owner had entered that holiday before

88%

of suggestions have exactly the right hours

94%

right about open or closed

96%

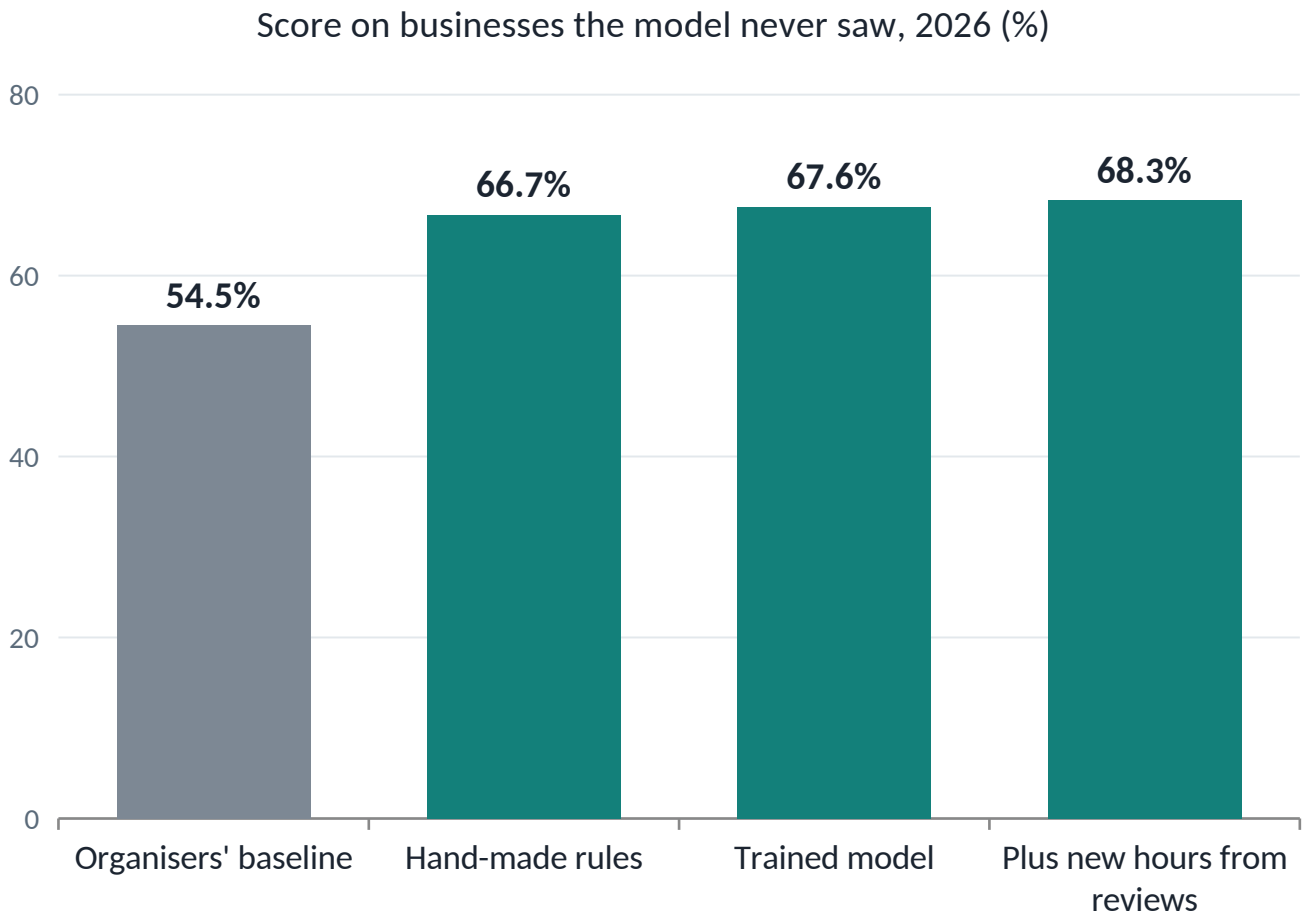
of lookups that would have hit a closed door, prevented

When they never had

Less to go on, and most owners keep their normal hours, so it speaks up on only 880 of 6,616 days. **Every answer moves an owner into the first group.**

802 dev businesses, 11,100 days, each decided by a model trained without it. Reproduce: uv run apps/predictor/train.py --check

What moved the score, and what didn't



What we learned

Copying similar businesses failed

Most owners without history keep their normal hours, so it mostly messaged owners who were already right.

Activity, neighbours, events

Each looked promising alone, but added nothing on top of the clues we had.

Perfect memory stops at 81.9%

Repeating exactly what every owner did last time. Owners change their habits.

The owner always has the last word

Nothing is published without approval or standing permission

What the owner answered or entered is never overruled

Quiet when unsure, or when a page the owner linked disagrees

Every suggestion keeps what was suggested and why

The same loop, other jobs

Outdated normal hours

Reviews like "new owner, new hours, Google has the old ones" were right in 14 of 15 businesses.

Closed for good

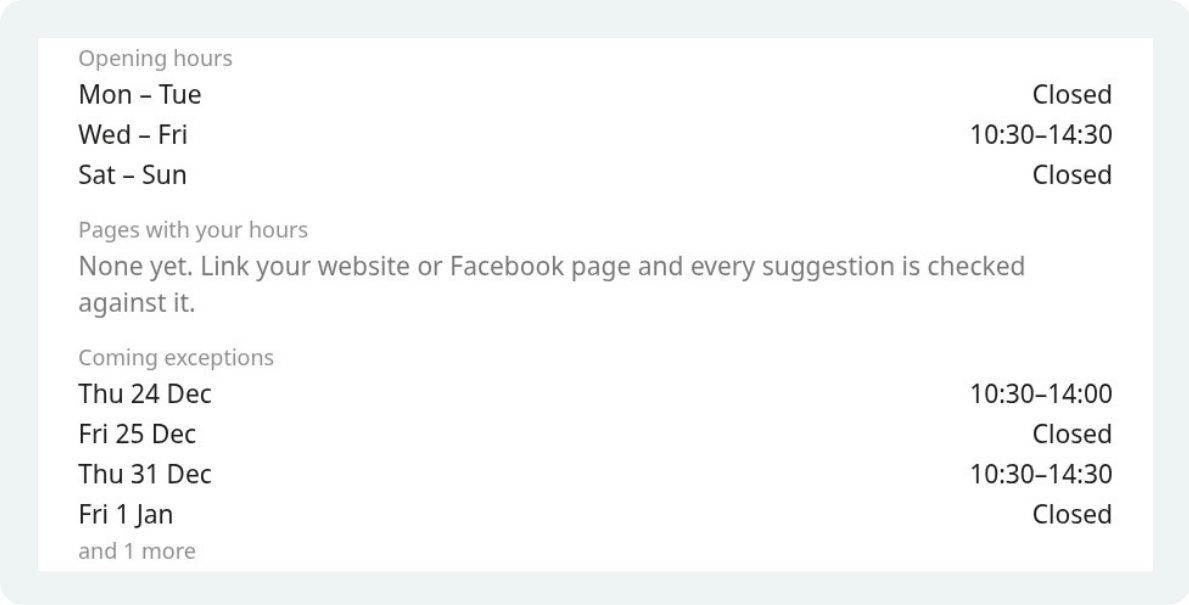
Already flagged for a person at Fonecta to check.

Review replies and posts

Detect, suggest, ask, apply: the same steps.

Live source: our Yext sandbox

We replaced entities.json and listings.json with Yext's Knowledge Graph Entities and Listings for the sandbox's businesses. They are read again each time the dashboard opens, and approved changes are written back.



Business Lunch House's hours read back from Yext after the owner's edit: Christmas Eve 10:30-14:00.

Coverage

Two test businesses, both in Tampere. 11 publishers live, among them Google, Facebook and Bing. No Nordic directories, no Apple Maps.

Quality

Fonecta's category id isn't one of the dataset's types, so we guess the type from the name. Google and Facebook say NOT_CONNECTED.

Gaps

No reviews, Google suggestions or past holiday hours, and Analytics returned a server error. The predictor relies on similar businesses.

Next steps

1

Ask when unsure

"Are you open on 26 December?" instead of a doubtful suggestion. Every answer teaches the model.

2

Outdated normal hours

Reviews like "new owner, new hours" were right in 14 of 15 businesses. The next suggestion type.

3

Retrain on everyone's answers

Each answer already updates that owner's suggestions. Next, the model also retrains on them, as on the pilot's.

4

More live sources

Shopping centres' feeds, business registers (PRH, Brønnøysund, Bolagsverket) and live weather.

Data: Connect Suggests simulator, Since AI ry 2026 (CC BY 4.0). All businesses are synthetic.